

GLYPH-X

a super regular RISC architecture

June 14, 2025 – v0.6.0-current

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Maya glyphs in stucco on display at the Museo de Sitio in Palenque, Mexico.

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to my mentors, whose guidance and wisdom made this work possible.

*"Perfection is achieved,
not when there is nothing more to add,
but when there is nothing left to take away."*

— Antoine de Saint-Exupéry

Contents

Preface	v
1. Architecture	1
1.1. Introduction	1
1.1.1. load-store	2
1.1.2. registers	2
1.1.3. memory	2
1.1.4. instructions	3
1.1.5. constants	4
1.2. Core concepts	5
1.3. Program streams	6
1.4. Instruction format	7
1.4.1. instruction templates	7
1.4.2. instruction sizes	8
1.4.3. instruction forms	8
1.4.4. instruction decoding	9
1.5. Register file	10
1.6. Example pipeline	11
2. System	12
2.1. System registers	12
2.1.1. user-level registers	13
2.1.2. privileged trap registers	14
2.1.3. privileged system registers	16
2.1.4. privileged debug registers	17
2.2. Address translation	18
2.2.1. page table structure	18
2.2.2. page table walker	19
3. Instructions	20
3.1. Instruction listing — 16-bit	20
3.1.1. break	20
3.1.2. j	20
3.1.3. b	20
3.1.4. ibj	21
3.1.5. link	21
3.1.6. movh	22

3.1.7. movw	22
3.1.8. movi	22
3.1.9. addi	22
3.1.10. srli	23
3.1.11. srai	23
3.1.12. slli	23
3.1.13. addh	23
3.1.14. leapc	24
3.1.15. loadpc	24
3.1.16. storepc	24
3.1.17. load	24
3.1.18. store	25
3.1.19. compare	25
3.1.20. logic	26
3.1.21. pin	26
3.1.22. and	27
3.1.23. or	27
3.1.24. xor	27
3.1.25. add	27
3.1.26. srl	28
3.1.27. sra	28
3.1.28. sll	28
3.1.29. sub	28
3.1.30. mul	29
3.1.31. div	29
3.1.32. illegal	29
4. Assembly	30
4.1. Introduction	30
4.2. Concepts	30
4.2.1. assembly	30
4.2.2. object	30
4.2.3. archive	30
4.2.4. executable	30
4.2.5. shared library	31
4.2.6. section	31
4.2.7. segment	31
4.2.8. symbol	31
4.2.9. relocation	31
4.2.10. program linking	31
4.3. Directives	32
4.4. Pseudo-instructions	33
4.5. Calling convention	34
4.5.1. calling convention — 16-bit	34

Contents

A. Appendix	35
A.1. Opcode summary — 16-bit	35
References	36

Preface

this document introduces a RISC architecture designed with simplicity as its dominating principle, along with several features not yet present in mainstream RISC architectures:

- a compression technique for split instruction and constant streams.
- a variable-length instruction format designed for vectorized decoding.
- an efficient frontier between hardware synthesis and software translation.

the document begins with a general introduction to RISC architectures, including principal elements such as load-store operation, memory, registers, instructions, and constants. it then presents an overview of the proposed architecture, followed by sections on program streams, the variable-length instruction format, the instruction set, its assembly syntax, and the programming language calling convention.

this document does not simply present an architecture that is a reimplementa-tion of existing ideas; rather, it introduces a novel architecture with an instruction coding scheme optimized for efficient parallel decoding in hardware or software, combined with contemporary practice in instruction semantics.

this work is intended for computer architects, systems programmers, students of computing machinery, and anyone interested in the evolution of RISC design. by the end of the document, readers should be able to reason about computer programs at the instruction level and understand the logic behind the architecture’s design choices—with enough detail to implement the architecture in hardware or software.

1. Architecture

1.1. Introduction

this section gives a brief introduction to RISC architectures.

A RISC¹ machine is a type of general-purpose computer with the characteristic that it has a reduced set of instructions in contrast to a CISC² machine. A RISC machine is Turing complete meaning it can perform any computation that a Turing machine can, given enough time and memory. a Turing machine [12] is a theoretical model of computation.

a RISC machine has a set of instructions which comprise basic operations such as: *load-from-memory*, *store-to-memory*, *add*, *subtract*, *compare*, plus *conditional branch* and *unconditional branch* instructions et cetera; which one can imagine as a list of instructions on a paper tape. each instruction has an *opcode*, which is a unique binary pattern that identifies the *operation*, plus several *operands*, which are arguments to the instruction.

```
register-0 = load-from-memory at tape-address-0
register-1 = load-from-memory at tape-address-1
register-2 = add register-0 and register-1
            store-to-memory register-2 at tape-address-2
```

some instructions have operands that point to values inside of *registers* in a *register-file* which is like a close filing cabinet containing cards with numbers on them, and some of these numbers are addresses that point to values in *main-memory* which is like a larger but slower filing cabinet. some of these values are *immediate* values which are small numbers listed inside of the instructions on the paper tape.

the paper tape is just a way conceptualize a list of instructions stored in *main-memory*. there is a special register called *PC* short for *program counter*, which points to the current position on the tape. after each instruction executes the tape is advanced to the next instruction and the *program counter* is incremented, until it encounters a *branch* instruction which causes it to move forwards or backwards to a different position on the tape. branch instructions can be *conditional* or *unconditional*. conditional branches are selectively executed based on the results of a comparison instruction.

¹Reduced Instruction Set Computer

²Complex Instruction Set Computer

1. Architecture

1.1.1. load-store

a *load-store* architecture [3] is a way to characterize RISC architectures where most instructions have simple operands that point to values held in registers, plus *load* and *store* instructions to retrieve and commit values to main memory. a *load-store* architecture alleviates the need to add complex addressing modes, plus input-output to peripherals and secondary storage use *MMIO*³ to avoid needing special *Input/Output* instructions.

1.1.2. registers

registers are temporary storage used to fill input and output operands for the ALU^4 before and after execution of instructions. registers are organized as a word-addressable store where each register number refers to $XLEN \in \{64, 128\}$ bits of data. $XLEN$ is a parameter that specifies the width of registers in bits.

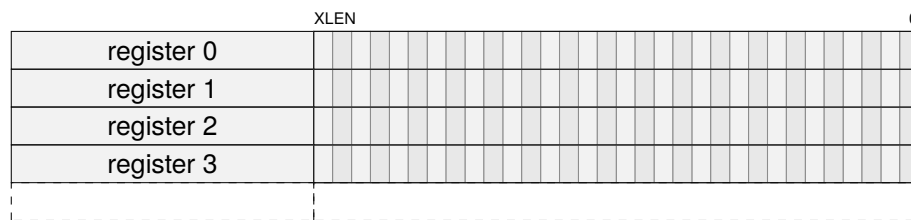


Figure 1.1.: organization of register storage.

1.1.3. memory

main memory is primary storage which in modern computers is most likely *DRAM*⁵. main memory is organized as a byte-addressable store where each address refers to a byte which is 8-bits of data. *ALEN* is a parameter that specifies the width of addresses in bits.

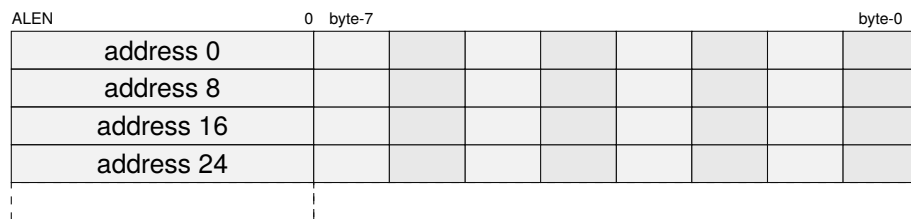


Figure 1.2.: organization of main-memory storage.

³*MMIO* - Memory-mapped I/O.

⁴ALU – Arithmetic logic unit.

⁵*DRAM* – Dynamic random-access memory.

1. Architecture

1.1.4. instructions

instruction memory is a memory region dedicated to program instructions. it is organized as a word-addressable store, similar to main memory, but is read-only and reserved exclusively for instructions. this configuration is typically referred to as a Harvard architecture [1], in contrast to a Von Neumann architecture [8, 9], which uses a shared memory region for both program instructions and data.

instruction words contain packets of 16-bits which are composed of size, opcode, and operand fields. instruction packets can be appended together to form larger instruction words with larger opcode and operand fields. section 1.4 provides details on the instruction template and instruction forms.

15	7	6	2	1	0
$operand_{[8:0]}$			$opcode_{[4:0]}$		$sz_{[1:0]}$

Figure 1.3.: 16-bit instruction containing one packet.

15	7	6	2	1	0
$operand_{[8:0]}$			$opcode_{[4:0]}$		$sz_{[1:0]}$
$operand_{[17:9]}$			$opcode_{[9:5]}$		$sz_{[3:2]}$

Figure 1.4.: 32-bit instruction containing two packets.

instruction words are packed together into instruction blocks containing instruction size information that is used to fuse them together to compose variable-length instructions [7]. instruction words can begin on any 16-bit aligned address. instruction memory is addressed with displacements from the *program counter* called *pc-relative* addresses.

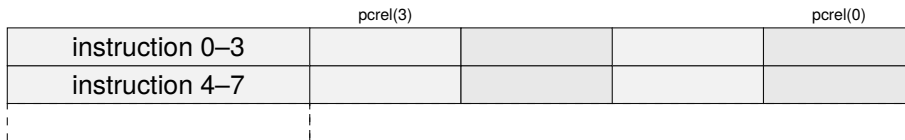


Figure 1.5.: organization of instruction-memory with 16-bit instructions.

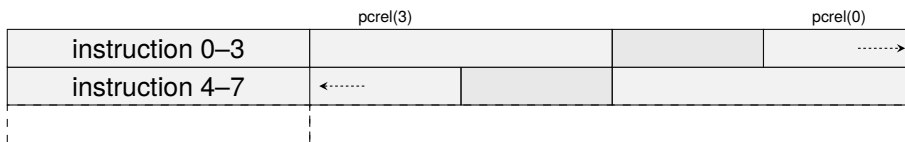


Figure 1.6.: organization of instruction-memory with 16-bit and 32-bit instructions.

1. Architecture

1.1.5. constants

constant memory [11] is a memory region dedicated to constants. it is organized as a word-addressable store like main-memory, but is read-only and restricted to constants. instructions can refer to constants using *ib-relative* addresses inside instruction operands. section 1.3 provides more details on the split instruction and constant streams.

constant memory is addressed with displacements from the *immediate base* register called *ib-relative* addresses which are stored inside instruction operand slots, are sized, scaled and aligned addresses computed relative to the *immediate base* register, which is like a program counter for constants. these diagrams show $ib8(n)$ through $ib64(n)$ *ib-relative* addresses for access to 8-bit through to 64-bit constants respectively: *note: ib-relative addresses alias a single constant storage space containing all types.*

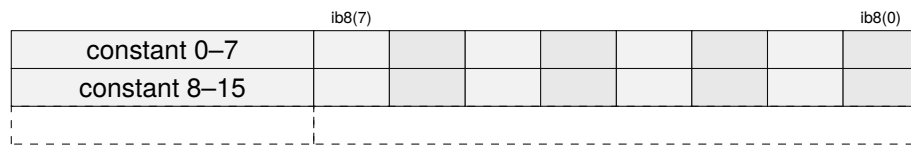


Figure 1.7.: organization of *ib8* constant-memory storage.

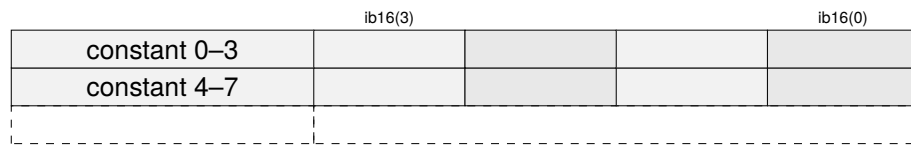


Figure 1.8.: organization of *ib16* constant-memory storage.

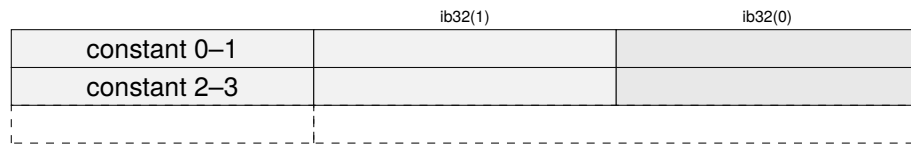


Figure 1.9.: organization of *ib32* constant-memory storage.

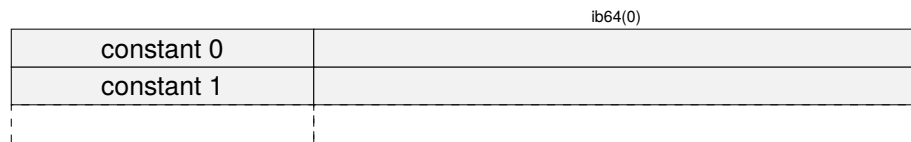


Figure 1.10.: organization of *ib64* constant-memory storage.

1.2. Core concepts

glyph is a super regular RISC architecture that encodes constants in a secondary stream accessed via an *immediate base* register that points at immediate blocks containing constants accessed via a constant address mode. the *immediate base* register branches like the *program counter*, and procedure calls and returns set and restore (*pc,ib*) together.

glyph uses relative address vectors in its link register which is different to typical RISC architectures. glyph does this so that the branch instructions can fit (*pc,ib*) into the a single link register for compatibility with traditional RISC architectures. glyph achieves this by packing two relative (*pc,ib*) displacements into a relative address vector⁶.

immediate blocks can be switched using the immediate block branch instruction. immediate blocks, unlike typical RISC architectures, mean that most relocations are word sized like CISC architectures, and can use C-style structure packing and alignment rules.

this list outlines some differentiating elements of the super regular RISC architecture:

- variable length instruction format supporting 16, 32, 64, and 128-bit instructions.
- 16-bit compressed instruction packets can access 8 registers.
- (*pc,ib*) is a *program counter* and *immediate base* register address vector.
- link register contains a packed relative (*pc,ib*) address vector to function entry.
- *ibj immediate-block-jump* adds a relative address to the *immediate base* register.
- *movw move-word-immediate-block* uses an unsigned displacement to access constants.
- *jalib jump-and-link-immediate-block* or *call link function* links address vector and adds constants to (*pc,ib*) and is used to branch the *program counter* and *immediate base* register at the same time for calling procedures.
- *jtlib jump-to-link-immediate-block* or *return link function* subtracts link vector from and adds constants to (*pc,ib*) and is used to branch the *program counter* and *immediate base* register at the same time for returning from called procedures.
- *pin pack-indirect* packs two absolute addresses as relative address vector from (*pc,ib*) and is used for calling absolute addresses such as virtual functions.

the *pin* and *link* instructions form a modular arithmetic ring of relative address vectors, due to their use of relative addresses. relative address vectors can be encrypted, decrypted, and authenticated to form a verifiable chain of addresses for control flow integrity.

⁶the architecture defines two parameters: *ALEN* and *XLEN*, which respectively refer to width of addresses and width of general purpose registers in bits. when $XLEN \geq ALEN \times 2$ it is possible to pack absolute addresses instead of relative addresses, as would be the case where $ALEN=64$ and $XLEN=128$.

1.3. Program streams

glyph separates the stored programs into two streams, one with instructions and one with constants [11]. the instruction stream is addressed with the *program counter* (*pc*) and the constant stream is addressed with the *immediate base* (*ib*) register. this could be referred to as split program stream Harvard architecture.

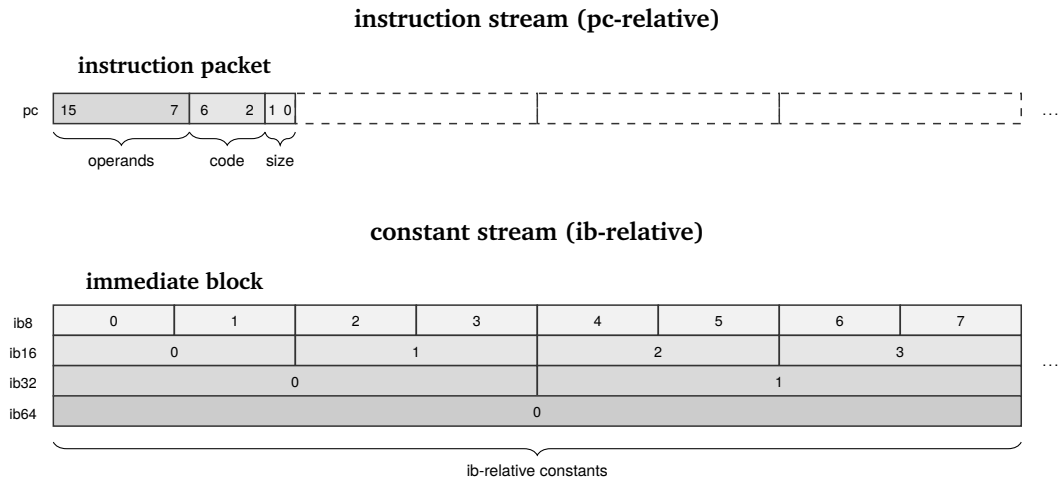


Figure 1.11.: program counter and immediate base register.

instruction blocks are aligned memory blocks addressed by the *program counter*. instruction memory is addressed with *pc-relative* addresses in instruction immediate values or indirectly with constants accessed using *ib-relative* addresses stored inside instruction operand slots.

immediate blocks are aligned memory blocks addressed by the *immediate base* register. constant memory is addressed with *ib-relative* addresses stored inside instruction operand slots, which are sized, scaled, and aligned relative to the *immediate base* register.

the constant stream branches independently using the *immediate-block-jump* instruction to update the *immediate base* register, or together with the *program counter* in procedure call and return instructions that branch instruction and constants at the same time; *jump-and-link-immediate-block* and *jump-to-link-immediate-block* add and subtract address vectors to (*pc,ib*). the *pack-indirect* instruction allows absolute (*pc,ib*) addresses to be packed into an address vector for indirect calls.

the instruction forms use bonded operand slots for immediate operands and operand bits do not overlap opcode bits. the use of immediate blocks means large immediate constants can all be accessed using short references encoded inside of operand slots for instructions that use an immediate block relative addressing mode.

1.4. Instruction format

instructions use a variable length format [7] with a 16-bit instruction packet that supports 16, 32, 64, and 128-bit instruction words. the instruction packet uses a *super regular* scheme, whereby successive instruction packets extend the fields in the previous instruction packet [6]. instruction words can begin on any 16-bit aligned address.

1.4.1. instruction templates

the variable length instruction format has a single base format where fields in the template instruction form are extended by successive instruction packets.

15	7	6	2	1	0
<i>operand</i> _[8:0]		<i>opcode</i> _[4:0]		<i>sZ</i> _[1:0]	

Figure 1.12.: instruction template — 16-bit.

15	7	6	2	1	0
<i>operand</i> _[8:0]		<i>opcode</i> _[4:0]		<i>sZ</i> _[1:0]	
<i>operand</i> _[17:9]		<i>opcode</i> _[9:5]		<i>sZ</i> _[3:2]	

Figure 1.13.: instruction template — 32-bit.

15	7	6	2	1	0
<i>operand</i> _[8:0]		<i>opcode</i> _[4:0]		<i>sZ</i> _[1:0]	
<i>operand</i> _[17:9]		<i>opcode</i> _[9:5]		<i>sZ</i> _[3:2]	
<i>operand</i> _[26:18]		<i>opcode</i> _[14:10]		<i>sZ</i> _[5:4]	
<i>operand</i> _[35:27]		<i>opcode</i> _[19:15]		<i>sZ</i> _[7:6]	

Figure 1.14.: instruction template — 64-bit.

15	7	6	2	1	0
<i>operand</i> _[8:0]		<i>opcode</i> _[4:0]		<i>sZ</i> _[1:0]	
<i>operand</i> _[17:9]		<i>opcode</i> _[9:5]		<i>sZ</i> _[3:2]	
<i>operand</i> _[26:18]		<i>opcode</i> _[14:10]		<i>sZ</i> _[5:4]	
<i>operand</i> _[35:27]		<i>opcode</i> _[19:15]		<i>sZ</i> _[7:6]	
<i>operand</i> _[44:36]		<i>opcode</i> _[24:20]		<i>sZ</i> _[9:8]	
<i>operand</i> _[53:45]		<i>opcode</i> _[29:25]		<i>sZ</i> _[11:10]	
<i>operand</i> _[62:54]		<i>opcode</i> _[34:30]		<i>sZ</i> _[13:12]	
<i>operand</i> _[71:63]		<i>opcode</i> _[39:35]		<i>sZ</i> _[15:14]	

Figure 1.15.: instruction template — 128-bit.

1. Architecture

1.4.2. instruction sizes

the variable length instruction format has a 2-bit size field inspired by LEB128 [4] in a fixed position in every instruction packet, to reduce the complexity of size-decoding for variable length instructions⁷. this table shows the size fields for the different instruction sizes:

Instruction size	Size vector
16-bit	{00}
32-bit	{01, 11}
64-bit	{10, 11, 11, 11}
128-bit	{11, 11, 11, 11, 11, 11, 11, 11}

Table 1.1.: variable-length instruction size fields

1.4.3. instruction forms

the instructions forms are super regular in that operand and opcode bits do not overlap and the number and complexity of the formats is reduced so that vectorized instruction decoding is simple in both hardware and software. the scheme is designed so that 1-bit of coding space in the larger packet can be used to extend register sizes.

16-bit instruction forms

this section details the layout of the 16-bit instruction forms:

15	7	6	2	1	0
$imm_{[5:0]}$			$opcode_{[4:0]}$	00	

Figure 1.16.: 16-bit large immediate.

15	13	12	7	6	2	1	0
$rc_{[2:0]}$		$imm_{[5:0]}$			$opcode_{[4:0]}$		00

Figure 1.17.: 16-bit one operand with immediate.

15	13	12	10	9	7	6	2	1	0
$rc_{[2:0]}$		$rb_{[2:0]}$		$imm_{[2:0]}$		$opcode_{[4:0]}$		00	

Figure 1.18.: 16-bit two operand with immediate.

15	13	12	10	9	7	6	2	1	0
$rc_{[2:0]}$		$rb_{[2:0]}$		$ra_{[2:0]}$		$opcode_{[4:0]}$		00	

Figure 1.19.: 16-bit three operand.

⁷instructions are considered *well-formed* if the size field of subsequent packets has the value 11.

1. Architecture

32-bit instruction forms

this section details the layout of the 32-bit instruction forms:

15	7	6	2	1	0
<i>imm</i> _[8:0]		<i>opcode</i> _[4:0]		01	
<i>imm</i> _[17:9]		<i>opcode</i> _[9:5]		11	

Figure 1.20.: 32-bit large immediate.

15	13	12	7	6	2	1	0
<i>rc</i> _[2:0]		<i>imm</i> _[5:0]		<i>opcode</i> _[4:0]		01	
<i>rc</i> _[5:3]		<i>imm</i> _[11:6]		<i>opcode</i> _[9:5]		11	

Figure 1.21.: 32-bit one operand with immediate.

15	13	12	10	9	7	6	2	1	0
<i>rc</i> _[2:0]		<i>rb</i> _[2:0]		<i>imm</i> _[2:0]		<i>opcode</i> _[4:0]		01	
<i>rc</i> _[5:3]		<i>rb</i> _[5:3]		<i>imm</i> _[5:3]		<i>opcode</i> _[9:5]		11	

Figure 1.22.: 32-bit two operand with immediate.

15	13	12	10	9	7	6	2	1	0
<i>rc</i> _[2:0]		<i>rb</i> _[2:0]		<i>ra</i> _[2:0]		<i>opcode</i> _[4:0]		01	
<i>rc</i> _[5:3]		<i>rb</i> _[5:3]		<i>ra</i> _[5:3]		<i>opcode</i> _[9:5]		11	

Figure 1.23.: 32-bit three operand.

1.4.4. instruction decoding

the instruction size encoding and field extension scheme has been designed to minimize complexity for parallel decoding in hardware and software. the following table shows the instruction width combinations for various width parallel instruction decoders.

Packets	Bits	Bytes	n_{combos}	$\log_2(n)$
1-wide	16-bit	2	1	0
2-wide	32-bit	4	16	4
4-wide	64-bit	8	58	5.86
8-wide	128-bit	16	574	9.16
16-wide	256-bit	32	51904	15.66

Table 1.2.: instruction decode combinations

1.5. Register file

the glyph register file is extensible due to the variable length instruction format and supports a different number of registers depending on the instruction size.

- 16-bit instruction packet can access 8 registers with up to 3 operands.
- 32-bit instruction packet can access 64 registers with up to 3 operands.
- 64-bit instruction packet can access 64 registers with up to 6 operands.

the register state accessible by the 16-bit instruction packet is comprised of:

- *program counter* register (aligned to 2 bytes).
- *immediate base* register (aligned to 64 bytes).
- 8 × general purpose registers (*r0* through *r7*).
- 1 × predicate register (*flag*).

the following diagram shows the register state accessible by the 16-bit instruction packet:

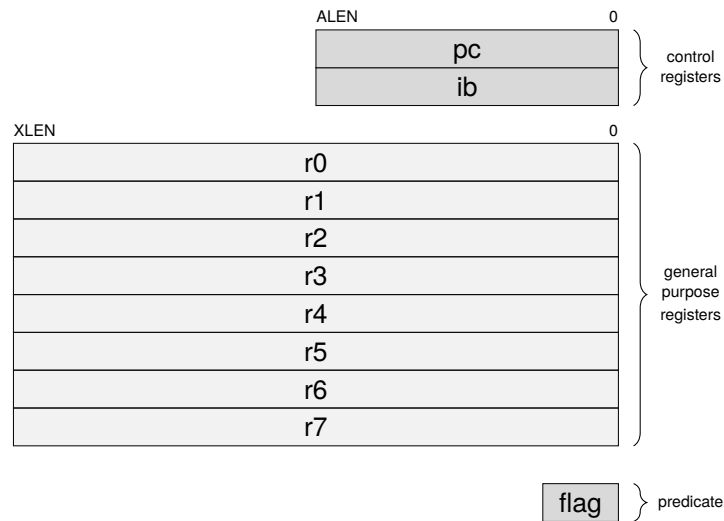


Figure 1.24.: register state accessible by 16-bit instruction packet.

the use of $ALEN^8$ and $XLEN^9$ parameters is to indicate that the width of addresses can be less than the width of the general purpose registers.

⁸ $ALEN$ refers to the width of addresses in bits.

⁹ $XLEN$ refers to the width of general purpose registers in bits.

1.6. Example pipeline

an illustrative micro-architecture is proposed based on the classic 5-stage RISC micro-architecture [10] with the addition of an *operand fetch* stage and a *constant memory* port. this revised 6-stage micro-architecture is composed of the following pipeline stages:

- IF — *instruction fetch*: reads instructions from memory into a fetch buffer.
- ID — *instruction decode*: decodes instruction length, opcode, and operands.
- OF — *operand fetch*: reads operands from register file and constant memory.
- EX — *execute*: performs logical operations or arithmetic on the operands.
- MA — *memory access*: loads data from or stores data to memory.
- WB — *writeback*: writes results back to the register file.

a simplified micro-architecture using those pipeline stages might look like this: this example omits hazard detection and forwarding logic for the sake of simplicity.

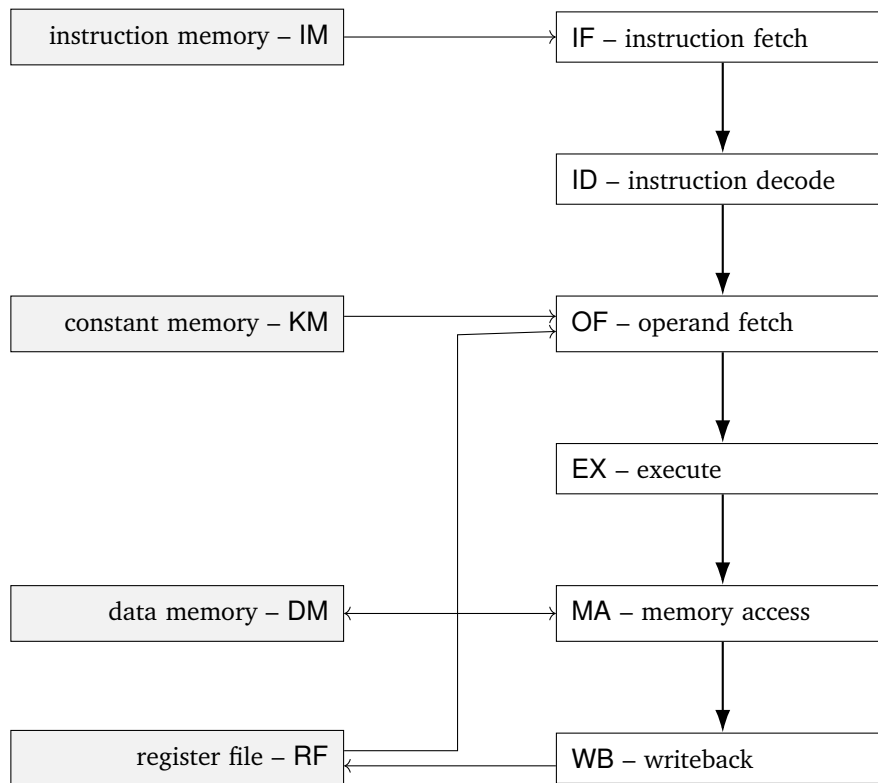


Figure 1.25.: sample 6-stage micro-architecture with support for constant memory.

2. System

2.1. System registers

the architecture provides several control and status registers for floating-point control and status, time, trap handling, address translation, timers, inter-thread interrupts, and debug.

this table gives an overview of the control and status registers.

no.	name	description
user-level registers		
0x00	fpcontrol	floating-point control
0x01	fpstatus	floating-point status
0x02	ctime	clock time
0x03	cfreq	clock frequency
privileged trap registers		
0x10	tcontrol	trap control
0x11	tstatus	trap status
0x12	tscratch	trap scratch
0x13	tepc	trap exception program counter
0x14	teib	trap exception immediate base
0x15	tval	trap value
0x16	tcause	trap cause
0x17	tack	trap acknowledge
0x18	thpc	trap handler program counter
0x19	thib	trap handler immediate base
privileged system registers		
0x20	scontrol	system control
0x21	sptr	system page table root
0x22	saddr	system thread address
0x23	starget	system target address
0x24	smessage	system message interrupt
0x25	stimer	system deadline timer
0x26	sie	system interrupt enable
0x27	sip	system interrupt pending
privileged debug registers		
0x30	dstatus	debug status
0x31	dcycle	debug cycle counter
0x32	dinst	debug instruction counter
0x33	dstop	debug stop instruction
0x34	dfetch	monitored fetch address
0x35	dread	monitored read address
0x36	dwrite	monitored write address

Table 2.1.: system registers

2. System

2.1.1. user-level registers

the section describes the user-level registers.

floating-point control (fpcontrol)

fpcontrol contains control information for floating-point operations. the RM field is a read-write and contains the current floating-point rounding mode.



no.	name	description
0	RN	round to nearest (even)
1	RD	round down (towards $-\infty$)
2	RU	round up (towards $+\infty$)
3	RZ	round towards zero (truncate)

Table 2.2.: floating-point control round mode field

floating-point status (fpstatus)

fpstatus contains status information for floating-point operations. the I, Z, U, O, and P fields are read-write and contain accrued floating-point exceptions.



no.	name	description
1 << 0	I	invalid operation
1 << 1	Z	divide by zero
1 << 2	U	numeric underflow
1 << 3	O	numeric overflow
1 << 4	P	inexact result

Table 2.3.: floating-point status flags

clock time (ctime)

ctime is a read-only register containing the wall-clock tick counter since power on in clock tick units denoted by cfreq.

clock frequency (cfreq)

cfreq is a read-only register containing the wall-clock tick interval in picoseconds; $\frac{10^{12}}{f}$ where f is the frequency in Hertz (Hz).

2. System

2.1.2. privileged trap registers

the section describes the privileged trap registers.

trap control (tcontrol)

tcontrol is a read-write register containing control bits. the I field is read-write and controls whether system interrupts are enabled for this hardware thread.

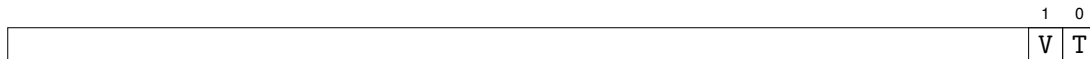


no.	name	description
1 << 0	I	system interrupt enable

Table 2.4.: trap control fields

trap status (tstatus)

tstatus contains status bits for the current trap. the T field is read-only and indicates whether a timer interrupt is pending. the V field is read-only and indicates whether a virtual interrupt is pending.



no.	name	description
1 << 0	T	timer interrupt pending
1 << 1	V	virtual interrupt pending

Table 2.5.: trap status fields

trap scratch (tscratch)

tscratch is a read-write save register for use during trap handling.

trap exception program counter (tepc)

tepc is a read-only register which contains the *program counter* address before the trap.

trap exception immediate base (teib)

teib is a read-only register which contains the *immediate base* address before the trap.

2. System

trap value (tval)

tval is a read-only register with a word indicating the identity of the trap, and may contain:

- the faulting instruction word for *break* and *illegal instruction exceptions*.
- the faulting address for *access* and *page faults*.
- the message value for *virtual interrupts*.
- the system clock time for *timer interrupts*.

trap cause (tcause)

tcause is a read-only register that contains the cause of the current trap, and may contain:

no.	name	description
system exceptions		
1	break-instruction	break instruction exception
2	illegal-instruction	illegal instruction exception
3	debug-monitor	debug monitor exception
4	misaligned-fetch	fetch misaligned
5	misaligned-load	load misaligned
6	misaligned-store	store misaligned
7	access-fault-fetch	fetch access fault
8	access-fault-load	load access fault
9	access-fault-store	store access fault
10	page-fault-fetch	fetch page fault
11	page-fault-load	load page fault
12	page-fault-store	store page fault
system interrupts		
30	timer-interrupt	timer interrupt
31	virtual-interrupt	virtual interrupt
32	interrupt-0	interrupt pin 0
...	...	...
63	interrupt-31	interrupt pin 31

Table 2.6.: trap causes

trap acknowledge (tack)

tack is a write-only register where the trap cause is written to acknowledge the trap so that interrupts are not delivered while state is being saved, and for double-faults to be detected.

trap handler program counter (thpc)

thpc is a read-write register containing the address of the system trap handler routine.

trap handler immediate base (thib)

thib is a read-write register containing the address of the system trap handler constants.

2. System

2.1.3. privileged system registers

the section describes the privileged system registers.

system control (scontrol)

scontrol is a read-write register containing control bits for address translation. the A field controls whether the user pages and be read or written by the supervisor. the E field controls whether user pages can be executed by the supervisor.

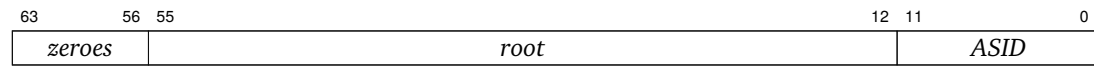


no.	name	description
1 << 0	A	supervisor access user pages
1 << 1	E	supervisor execute user pages

Table 2.7.: system control fields

system page table root (sptr)

sptr is a read-write register containing the page table root for address translation on this hardware thread. the ASID field contains the address space identifier for the current thread. the root field contains the physical address of the page table root structure.



system address (saddr)

saddr is a read-only register containing the system-wide address for this hardware thread.

system target (starget)

starget is a read-write register containing the system-wide address for a hardware thread that is the target of edge-triggered virtual interrupts. a target address of all-zeros is the boot service processor. a target address of all-ones is the broadcast address for all threads.

system message (smessage)

smessage is a write-only register to cause an edge-triggered virtual interrupt to be queued to the hardware thread set in starget. if interrupts are not enabled on the target hardware thread, the virtual interrupt is delivered when next enabled.

2. System

system timer (stimer)

stimer is a read-write register containing the deadline timer for this hardware thread. when the system clock reaches the value in the register, a *timer interrupt* is triggered. if interrupts are not enabled on this hardware thread, the timer interrupt is delivered when next enabled.

system interrupt enable (sie)

sie is a read-write register that contains interrupt enable flags for 32 wired interrupt pins.

system interrupt pending (sip)

sip is a read-only register that contains interrupt pending flags for 32 wired interrupt pins.

2.1.4. privileged debug registers

the section describes the privileged debug registers.

debug status (dstatus)

dstatus is a read-only register containing status bits for debug monitor exceptions.

	3	2	1	0
	W	R	F	S

no.	name	description
1 << 0	S	stopping instruction
1 << 1	F	fetch monitor address
1 << 2	R	load monitor address
1 << 3	W	store monitor address

Table 2.8.: debug status fields

debug cycle counter (dcycle)

dcycle is a read-only register containing the number of cycles retired since power on.

debug instruction counter (dinst)

dinst is a read-only register containing the number of instructions retired since power on.

debug stop instruction (dstop)

dstop is a read-write register containing an instruction number to halt execution on and raise a *debug monitor exception*.

2. System

debug monitor fetch (dfetch)

dfetch is a read-write register containing a memory fetch address to monitor for and halt execution on and raise a *debug monitor exception* for a matching memory fetch address.

debug monitor read (dread)

dread is a read-write register containing the memory load address to monitor for and halt execution on and raise a *debug monitor exception* for a matching memory load address.

debug monitor write (dwrite)

dwrite is a read-write register containing the memory store address to monitor for and halt execution on and raise a *debug monitor exception* for a matching memory store address.

2.2. Address translation

2.2.1. page table structure

the section describes the page table structure and dimensions for memory address translation pointed to by the *system page table root* register.

Levels	VPN ¹ bits	Page bits	Virt bits	Phys bits	Entry bits	Entries	Page sizes
4	9	12	48	56	64	512	4KiB, 2MiB, 1GiB

Table 2.9.: 64-bit page table dimensions

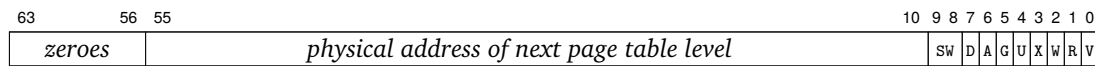


Figure 2.1.: 64-bit page table entry structure.

no.	name	description
1 << 0	V	valid
1 << 1	R	read
1 << 2	W	write
1 << 3	X	execute
1 << 4	U	user
1 << 5	G	global
1 << 6	A	accessed
1 << 7	D	dirty
3 << 8	SW	software

Table 2.10.: page table entry fields

¹Virtual Page Number

2. System

2.2.2. page table walker

the page table walker performs page table lookups to translate 64-bit virtual addresses to 64-bit physical addresses. there are 48 active bits in virtual addresses and the remaining bits are sign-extended. physical addresses have 56-bits and the upper 8-bits are zeroes.

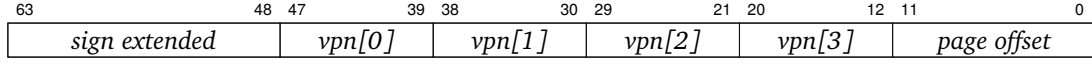


Figure 2.2.: 64-bit lookup virtual address structure.

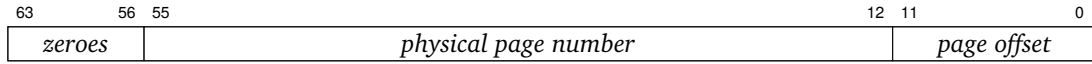


Figure 2.3.: 64-bit translated physical address structure.

the page table address translation process is as follows:

Algorithm 1 translate virtual address to physical address

```

1: function TRANSLATE(va)
2:   if  $\neg \text{CHECK\_CANONICAL}(va, va\_bits)$  then                                 $\triangleright$  check address is sign-extended
3:     raise fault
4:   end if
5:    $ppn = sptr.root \ll page\_bits$                                             $\triangleright$  fetch the page table root pointer
6:   for  $level = 1$  to  $num\_levels$  do
7:      $shift = (num\_levels - level) \times vpn\_bits + page\_bits$                  $\triangleright$  calculate virtual page number
8:      $vpn = (va \gg shift) \wedge ((1 \ll vpn\_bits) - 1)$ 
9:      $pte = \text{LOAD\_64}(ppn + vpn * pte\_size)$                                  $\triangleright$  load PTE
10:    if  $\neg pte.V$  then                                                        $\triangleright$  check valid
11:      raise fault
12:    else if  $\neg (pte.R \vee pte.W \vee pte.X)$  then                             $\triangleright$  no read, write or exec is a pointer
13:       $ppn = pte.ppn$ 
14:      continue
15:    else if  $pte.W \wedge \neg pte.R$  then                                          $\triangleright$  check write must have read
16:      raise fault
17:    else if  $(pte.R \wedge \neg pte.A) \vee (pte.W \wedge \neg pte.D)$  then             $\triangleright$  check accessed or dirty
18:      raise fault
19:    else if  $mode = S \wedge \neg scontrol.E \wedge pte.U \wedge (pte.X)$  then         $\triangleright$  check execute user page
20:      raise fault
21:    else if  $mode = S \wedge \neg scontrol.A \wedge pte.U \wedge (pte.R \vee pte.W)$  then  $\triangleright$  check access user page
22:      raise fault
23:    else if  $pte.ppn \wedge ((1 \ll (shift - page\_bits)) - 1)$  then             $\triangleright$  check superpage is aligned
24:      raise fault
25:    end if
26:    return  $(ppn \ll page\_bits) + (va \wedge ((1 \ll (page\_bits + level \times vpn\_bits)) - 1))$ 
27:  end for
28: end function

```

3. Instructions

3.1. Instruction listing — 16-bit

3.1.1. break

15	7	6	2	1	0
<i>imm9</i>		<i>opcode</i>	<i>size</i>		
uimm		00000	00		

break *uimm9*

the *break* instruction causes a debugger trap. *program counter* and trap cause are saved to privileged registers for the operating system to dispatch to a debugger and the *program counter* is set to a trap vector address.

3.1.2. j

15	7	6	2	1	0
<i>imm9</i>		<i>opcode</i>	<i>size</i>		
simm		00001	00		

j *simm9* × 2

the *j* or *jump* instruction is an unconditional branch instruction that adds a relative immediate address to the *program counter*. the resulting *program counter* address is [*pc* + *simm9* × 2].

$$pc = pc + simm9 * 2$$

3.1.3. b

15	7	6	2	1	0
<i>imm9</i>		<i>opcode</i>	<i>size</i>		
simm		00010	00		

b *simm9* × 2

the *b* or *branch* instruction is a conditional branch instruction that adds a relative immediate address to the *program counter*. if the *flag* register has been set by a compare instruction, the resulting *program counter* address is [*pc* + *simm9* × 2], otherwise the *program counter* is advanced normally.

```
if flag:
    pc = pc + simm9 * 2
```

3. Instructions

3.1.4. ibj

15	7	6	2	1	0
<i>imm9</i>			<i>opcode</i>	<i>size</i>	
simm			00011	00	

ibj $\text{simm9} \times 64$

the *ibj* or *immediate-block-jump* instruction adds a 64-bit relative address to the *immediate base* register. the resulting *immediate base* address is $[ib + \text{simm9} \times 64]$.

$$ib = ib + \text{simm9} * 64$$

3.1.5. link

15	13	12	7	6	2	1	0
<i>rc</i>		<i>imm6</i>		<i>opcode</i>	<i>size</i>		
fun		uimm		00100	00		

link.i64 $\text{fun3}, \text{ib64}(\text{uimm6})$

the *link* instruction loads a 64-bit constant addressed by $[ib + \text{uimm6} \times 8]$ containing a *i32x2* relative address vector, which it adds it to (pc, ib) , conditionally subtracts the source link register (*r6* or *r7*), then conditionally adds the difference to the destination link register (*r6* or *r7*), depending on the value of *fun3*. the type of linkage in *fun3* can be one of:

value	mnemonic	description	link-type	dst-link	src-link
0	jib	jump	jump	-	-
1	-	-	-	-	-
2	jalib	jump-and-link	call	r6	-
3	jalib	jump-and-link	call	r7	-
4	jtlib	jump-to-link	ret	-	r6
5	jtlib	jump-to-link	ret	-	r7
6	jalaib	jump-and-link-add	tail	r6	-
7	jalaib	jump-and-link-add	tail	r7	-

Table 3.1.: Link instruction functions

```

lr = 0b110 + (fun3 & 1)
cval = const-mem<i32x2>[ib + uimm6 * 8]
dval = fun3 == jalaib ? cval + auth-decrypt(reg<i32x2>[lr]) : cval
lval = fun3 == jtlib ?      auth-decrypt(reg<i32x2>[lr]) : 0
(dpc,dib) = dval
(lpc,lib) = lval
pc = pc + dpc - lpc
ib = ib + dib - lib
if fun3 == jalib or fun3 == jalaib:
    reg[lr] = auth-encrypt(reg<i32x2>(dpc,dib))

```

the *auth-encrypt* and *auth-decrypt* functions are placeholders for authenticated encryption, and decryption of relative address vectors. authentication failures should generate a trap for the operating system to dispatch to a control flow integrity trap handler.

3. Instructions

3.1.6. movh

15	13	12	7	6	2	1	0
<i>rc</i>	<i>imm6</i>			<i>opcode</i>	<i>size</i>		
rc	uimm			00101	00		

movh.i64 *rc*, *ib32*(*uimm6*)

the *movh* or *move-half-immediate-block* instruction loads a 32-bit constant addressed by [*ib* + *uimm6* × 4], which it sign-extends to 64-bits, then saves to the *rc* register.

$$\text{reg}[\text{rc}] = \text{const-mem}\langle\text{i32}\rangle[\text{ib} + \text{uimm6} * 4]$$

3.1.7. movw

15	13	12	7	6	2	1	0
<i>rc</i>	<i>imm6</i>			<i>opcode</i>	<i>size</i>		
rc	uimm			00110	00		

movw.i64 *rc*, *ib64*(*uimm6*)

the *movw* or *move-word-immediate-block* instruction loads a 64-bit constant addressed by [*ib* + *uimm6* × 8] then saves it to the *rc* register.

$$\text{reg}[\text{rc}] = \text{const-mem}\langle\text{i64}\rangle[\text{ib} + \text{uimm6} * 8]$$

3.1.8. movi

15	13	12	7	6	2	1	0
<i>rc</i>	<i>imm6</i>			<i>opcode</i>	<i>size</i>		
rc	simm			00111	00		

movi.i64 *rc*, *simm6*

the *movi* or *move-immediate* instruction sign-extends the immediate value in *simm6* then saves the result in the *rc* register.

$$\text{reg}[\text{rc}] = \text{simm6}$$

3.1.9. addi

15	13	12	7	6	2	1	0
<i>rc</i>	<i>imm6</i>			<i>opcode</i>	<i>size</i>		
rc	simm			01000	00		

addi.i64 *rc*, *simm6*

the *addi* or *add-immediate* instruction sign-extends the immediate value in *simm6* then adds it to the *rc* register.

$$\text{reg}[\text{rc}] = \text{reg}[\text{rc}] + \text{simm6}$$

3. Instructions

3.1.10. srli

15	13	12	7	6	2	1	0
<i>rc</i>	<i>imm6</i>			<i>opcode</i>	<i>size</i>		
rc	uimm			01001	00		

srli.i64 *rc*, *uimm6*

the *srli* or *shift-right-logical-immediate* instruction performs a logical right shift by *uimm6* bits of the value in the *rc* register. zeros are copied into the left most bits.

$$\text{reg}[rc] = \text{reg}\langle u64 \rangle[rc] \gg uimm6$$

3.1.11. srai

15	13	12	7	6	2	1	0
<i>rc</i>	<i>imm6</i>			<i>opcode</i>	<i>size</i>		
rc	uimm			01010	00		

srai.i64 *rc*, *uimm6*

the *srai* or *shift-right-arithmetic-immediate* instruction performs an arithmetic right shift by *uimm6* bits of the value in the *rc* register. the sign is copied into the left most bits.

$$\text{reg}[rc] = \text{reg}\langle i64 \rangle[rc] \gg uimm6$$

3.1.12. slli

15	13	12	7	6	2	1	0
<i>rc</i>	<i>imm6</i>			<i>opcode</i>	<i>size</i>		
rc	uimm			01011	00		

slli.i64 *rc*, *uimm6*

the *slli* or *shift-left-logical-immediate* instruction performs a logical left shift by *uimm6* bits of the value in the *rc* register. zeros are copied into the right most bits.

$$\text{reg}[rc] = \text{reg}[rc] \ll uimm6$$

3.1.13. addh

15	13	12	7	6	2	1	0
<i>rc</i>	<i>imm6</i>			<i>opcode</i>	<i>size</i>		
rc	uimm			01100	00		

addh.i64 *rc*, *ib32*(*uimm6*)

the *addh* or *add-half-immediate-block* instruction loads a 32-bit constant addressed by [*ib* + *uimm6* × 4], which it sign-extends to 64-bits, then adds to the *rc* register.

$$\text{reg}[rc] = \text{reg}[rc] + \text{const-mem}\langle i32 \rangle[ib + uimm6 * 4]$$

3. Instructions

3.1.14. leapc

15	13	12	7	6	2	1	0
<i>rc</i>	<i>imm6</i>			<i>opcode</i>	<i>size</i>		
rc	uimm			01101	00		

leapc.i64 *rc*, *ib*32(*uimm6*)(*pc*)

the *leapc* or *load-effective-address-pc* instruction loads a 32-bit constant addressed by [*ib* + *uimm6* × 4], which it sign-extends to 64-bits, adds it to the *program counter*, and saves the result in the *rc* register.

$$\text{reg}[\text{rc}] = \text{pc} + \text{const-mem}\langle\text{i32}\rangle[\text{ib} + \text{uimm6} * 4]$$

3.1.15. loadpc

15	13	12	7	6	2	1	0
<i>rc</i>	<i>imm6</i>			<i>opcode</i>	<i>size</i>		
rc	uimm			01110	00		

loadpc.i64 *rc*, *ib*32(*uimm6*)(*pc*)

the *loadpc* instruction loads a 32-bit constant addressed by [*ib* + *uimm6* × 4] which it sign-extends to 64-bit, adds it to the *program counter* to form an address, then loads a 64-bit value from memory at that address and saves the result in the *rc* register.

$$\text{reg}[\text{rc}] = \text{mem}\langle\text{i64}\rangle[\text{pc} + \text{const-mem}\langle\text{i32}\rangle[\text{ib} + \text{uimm6} * 4]]$$

3.1.16. storepc

15	13	12	7	6	2	1	0
<i>rc</i>	<i>imm6</i>			<i>opcode</i>	<i>size</i>		
rc	uimm			01111	00		

storepc.i64 *rc*, *ib*32(*uimm6*)(*pc*)

the *storepc* instruction loads a 32-bit constant addressed by [*ib* + *uimm6* × 4] which it sign-extends to 64-bit, adds it to the *program counter* to form an address, then stores to memory at that address a 64-bit value from the *rc* register.

$$\text{mem}\langle\text{i64}\rangle[\text{pc} + \text{const-mem}\langle\text{i32}\rangle[\text{ib} + \text{uimm6} * 4]] = \text{reg}[\text{rc}]$$

3.1.17. load

15	13	12	10	9	7	6	2	1	0
<i>rc</i>	<i>rb</i>	<i>imm3</i>		<i>opcode</i>		<i>size</i>			
rc	rb	uimm		10000		00			

load.i64 *rc*, (*uimm3* × 8)(*rb*)

the *load* instruction computes the address [*rb* + *uimm3* × 8] then loads a 64-bit value from memory at that address and saves the result in the *rc* register.

$$\text{reg}[\text{rc}] = \text{mem}\langle\text{i64}\rangle[\text{reg}[\text{rb}] + \text{uimm3} * 8]$$

3. Instructions

3.1.18. store

15	13	12	10	9	7	6	2	1	0
<i>rc</i>	<i>rb</i>	<i>imm3</i>	<i>opcode</i>	<i>size</i>					
rc	rb	uimm	10001	00	store.i64 <i>rc</i> , (<i>uimm3</i> × 8)(<i>rb</i>)				

the *store* instruction computes the address $[rb + uimm3 \times 8]$ then stores a 64-bit value to memory at that address containing a 64-bit value from the *rc* register.

$$\text{mem}\langle i64 \rangle[\text{reg}[rb] + uimm3 * 8] = \text{reg}[rc]$$

3.1.19. compare

15	13	12	10	9	7	6	2	1	0
<i>rc</i>	<i>rb</i>	<i>imm3</i>	<i>opcode</i>	<i>size</i>					
rc	rb	fun	10010	00	cmp.i64 <i>rc</i> , <i>rb</i> , <i>fun3</i>				

the *compare* instruction performs a comparison between the value in *rb* and *rc* then saves the result in the *flag* register. the *compare* opcode is also used to perform conditional move whereby the *rb* register is copied into the *rc* if the *flag* register is set. the type of comparison in *fun3* can be one of:

value	mnemonic	description
0	<i>lt</i>	<i>less than (signed)</i>
1	<i>ge</i>	<i>greater or equal (signed)</i>
2	<i>eq</i>	<i>equal</i>
3	<i>ne</i>	<i>not equal</i>
4	<i>ltu</i>	<i>less than (unsigned)</i>
5	<i>geu</i>	<i>greater or equal (unsigned)</i>
6	<i>cmov</i>	<i>conditional move</i>
7	<i>ncmov</i>	<i>negated conditional move</i>

Table 3.2.: Compare instruction functions

```

match fun3
| lt    -> flag = reg<i64>[rc] < reg<i64>[rb]
| ge    -> flag = reg<i64>[rc] >= reg<i64>[rb]
| eq    -> flag = reg[rc] == reg[rb]
| ne    -> flag = reg[rc] != reg[rb]
| ltu   -> flag = reg<u64>[rc] < reg<u64>[rb]
| geu   -> flag = reg<u64>[rc] >= reg<u64>[rb]
| cmov  -> if flag:
            reg[rc] = reg[rb]
| ncmov -> if not flag:
            reg[rc] = reg[rb]

```


3. Instructions

3.1.20. logic

15	13	12	10	9	7	6	2	1	0
<i>rc</i>	<i>rb</i>	<i>imm3</i>	<i>opcode</i>	<i>size</i>					
rc	rb	fun	10011	00					

logic.i64 *rc,rb,fun3*

the *logic* instruction performs a logic operation on the value in the *rb* register then stores the result in the *rc* register. the type of logic operations in *fun3* can be one of:

value	mnemonic	description
0	<i>mv</i>	<i>move</i>
1	<i>not</i>	<i>logical not</i>
2	<i>neg</i>	<i>negate</i>
3	<i>bswap</i>	<i>bswap</i>
4	<i>ctz</i>	<i>count trailing zeros</i>
5	<i>clz</i>	<i>count leading zeros</i>
6	<i>ctpop</i>	<i>count population</i>
7	<i>sext</i>	<i>sign extend</i>

Table 3.3.: Logic instruction functions

```
match fun3
| mov  -> reg[rc] = reg[rb]
| not  -> reg[rc] = ~reg[rb]
| neg  -> reg[rc] = -reg[rb]
| bswap -> reg[rc] = bswap(reg[rb])
| ctz  -> reg[rc] = ctz(reg[rb])
| clz  -> reg[rc] = clz(reg[rb])
| ctpop -> reg[rc] = ctpop(reg[rb])
| sext -> reg[rc] = sext(reg[rb])
```

3.1.21. pin

15	13	12	10	9	7	6	2	1	0
<i>rc</i>	<i>rb</i>	<i>ra</i>	<i>opcode</i>	<i>size</i>					
rc	rb	ra	10100	00					

pin.i64 *rc,rb,ra*

the *pin* or *pack-indirect* instruction packs two absolute addresses as an *i32x2* (*pc,ib*) relative address vector. the register *ra* is subtracted from the *program counter*, and the register *rb* is subtracted from the *immediate base* register, and the results are packed into an *i32x2* relative address vector and saved to the register *rc*.

```
lpc  = int<i32>(pc - reg[ra])
lib  = int<i32>(ib - reg[rb])
lval = (lpc,lib)
reg[rc] = auth-encrypt(lval)
```

3. Instructions

3.1.22. and

15	13	12	10	9	7	6	2	1	0
<i>rc</i>	<i>rb</i>	<i>ra</i>	<i>opcode</i>				<i>size</i>		
rc	rb	ra	10101				00		

and.i64 *rc,rb,ra*

the *and* instruction performs a *logical-and* of the register *rb* and the register *ra* and saves the result in the register *rc*.

$$\text{reg}[rc] = \text{reg}[rb] \ \& \ \text{reg}[ra]$$

3.1.23. or

15	13	12	10	9	7	6	2	1	0
<i>rc</i>	<i>rb</i>	<i>ra</i>	<i>opcode</i>				<i>size</i>		
rc	rb	ra	10110				00		

or.i64 *rc,rb,ra*

the *or* instruction performs a *logical-or* of the register *rb* and the register *ra* and saves the result in the register *rc*.

$$\text{reg}[rc] = \text{reg}[rb] \ | \ \text{reg}[ra]$$

3.1.24. xor

15	13	12	10	9	7	6	2	1	0
<i>rc</i>	<i>rb</i>	<i>ra</i>	<i>opcode</i>				<i>size</i>		
rc	rb	ra	10111				00		

xor.i64 *rc,rb,ra*

the *xor* instruction performs a *logical-exclusive-or* of the register *rb* and the register *ra* and saves the result in the register *rc*.

$$\text{reg}[rc] = \text{reg}[rb] \ \wedge \ \text{reg}[ra]$$

3.1.25. add

15	13	12	10	9	7	6	2	1	0
<i>rc</i>	<i>rb</i>	<i>ra</i>	<i>opcode</i>				<i>size</i>		
rc	rb	ra	11000				00		

add.i64 *rc,rb,ra*

the *add* instruction adds the *rb* register to the *ra* register and saves the result in the *rc* register.

$$\text{reg}[rc] = \text{reg}[rb] \ + \ \text{reg}[ra]$$

3. Instructions

3.1.26. srl

15	13	12	10	9	7	6	2	1	0
<i>rc</i>	<i>rb</i>	<i>ra</i>	<i>opcode</i>				<i>size</i>		
rc	rb	ra	11001				00		

srl.i64 *rc,rb,ra*

the *srl* or *shift-right-logical* instruction performs a logical right shift of the value in the *rb* register by the number of bits in register *ra* then saves the result in the *rc* register. zeros are copied into the right most bits.

$$\text{reg}[rc] = \text{reg}\langle u64 \rangle[rb] \gg \text{reg}[ra]$$

3.1.27. sra

15	13	12	10	9	7	6	2	1	0
<i>rc</i>	<i>rb</i>	<i>ra</i>	<i>opcode</i>				<i>size</i>		
rc	rb	ra	11010				00		

sra.i64 *rc,rb,ra*

the *sra* or *shift-right-arithmetic* instruction performs an arithmetic right shift of the value in the *rb* register by the number of bits in register *ra* then saves the result in the *rc* register. sign is copied into the right most bits.

$$\text{reg}[rc] = \text{reg}\langle i64 \rangle[rb] \gg \text{reg}[ra]$$

3.1.28. sll

15	13	12	10	9	7	6	2	1	0
<i>rc</i>	<i>rb</i>	<i>ra</i>	<i>opcode</i>				<i>size</i>		
rc	rb	ra	11011				00		

sll.i64 *rc,rb,ra*

the *sll* or *shift-left-logical* instruction performs a logical left shift of the value in the *rb* register by the number of bits in register *ra* then saves the result in the *rc* register.

$$\text{reg}[rc] = \text{reg}[rb] \ll \text{reg}[ra]$$

3.1.29. sub

15	13	12	10	9	7	6	2	1	0
<i>rc</i>	<i>rb</i>	<i>ra</i>	<i>opcode</i>				<i>size</i>		
rc	rb	ra	11100				00		

sub.i64 *rc,rb,ra*

the *sub* instruction subtracts the *ra* register from the *rb* register and saves the result in the *rc* register.

$$\text{reg}[rc] = \text{reg}[rb] - \text{reg}[ra]$$

3. Instructions

3.1.30. mul

15	13	12	10	9	7	6	2	1	0
<i>rc</i>	<i>rb</i>	<i>ra</i>	<i>opcode</i>				<i>size</i>		
rc	rb	ra	11101				00		

mul.i64 *rc,rb,ra*

the *mul* instruction performs signed multiplication of the *rb* register with the *ra* register and saves the result in the *rc* register.

```
reg[rc] = reg[rb] * reg[ra]
```

3.1.31. div

15	13	12	10	9	7	6	2	1	0
<i>rc</i>	<i>rb</i>	<i>ra</i>	<i>opcode</i>				<i>size</i>		
rc	rb	ra	11110				00		

div.i64 *rc,rb,ra*

the *div* instruction performs signed division of the *rb* register by the *ra* register and saves the result in the *rc* register. division by zero causes the flag to be set and zero to be stored in the *rc* register. a subsequent branch can handle the division by zero.

```
flag = reg[ra] == 0
if flag:
    reg[rc] = 0
else:
    reg[rc] = reg[rb] / reg[ra]
```

3.1.32. illegal

15	7	6	2	1	0
<i>imm9</i>			<i>opcode</i>	<i>size</i>	
uimm			11111	00	

illegal *uimm9*

the *illegal* instruction causes an illegal instruction trap. *program counter* and trap cause are saved to privileged registers for the operating system to dispatch to an illegal instruction handler and the *program counter* is set to a trap vector address.

4. Assembly

4.1. Introduction

this glyph assembly language reference begins with an introduction to assembler and linker concepts and terminology, followed by sections describing the glyph assembler directives, and pseudo-instruction aliases. section 3 contains a complete listing of instruction.

4.2. Concepts

this section covers assembler high level concepts required to understand the concepts involved in assembling and linking executable code from source files. the terminology used in this section is applicable to the PE/COFF, ELF and Mach-O file formats.

4.2.1. assembly

assembly files contains assembly language directives, macros and instructions describing program code and data. they can be handwritten or emitted by a compiler. an assembly file is the input file to the assembler and the output from the assembler is an object file.

4.2.2. object

object files contain compiled relocatable object code and data emitted by the assembler. an object file cannot be run, rather it is used as input to the linker in a program linking step which combines them to produce an executable file or shared library.

4.2.3. archive

archive files contain collections of relocatable object files and are typically referred to as static libraries. archive files use a simple format that appends together a set of object files with an index listing the object files contained in the archive. thin archive files just contain the index listing the object files without any associated data.

4.2.4. executable

executable files contain compiled relocatable object code and data that has been linked together by a linker in a program linking step using multiple object files, archive files and shared libraries as input. executable files can be statically or dynamically linked. dynamically linked executables files express dependencies on shared libraries.

4.2.5. shared library

shared library files contain compiled relocatable object code and data that have been linked together by a linker in a program linking step using multiple object files, archive files and shared libraries as input. shared libraries are dynamically linked by a runtime linker, and they express dependencies on other shared libraries which need to be loaded at runtime.

4.2.6. section

a section is a name for a region of code or data in an object file, executable file or shared library file. the files can be made up of multiple sections where each section corresponds to several types of executable code or data. this list contains the most common types:

- `.text` is a read-only section containing executable code
- `.const` is a read-only section containing immediate blocks
- `.data` is a read-write section containing global or static variables
- `.rodata` is a read-only section containing read-only variables
- `.bss` is a read-write section containing uninitialized data

4.2.7. segment

segments are loadable regions of code or data in an an executable or shared library. segments describe virtual addresses, file offsets and memory access permissions for mapped sections. in ELF, a segment can map to one or more sections. in PE/COFF sections are mapped directly. in Mach-O, sections are contained within a small set of specific segment types.

4.2.8. symbol

symbols are metadata table entries that contains a name with a mapping to an address. symbols are present in object files and dynamic symbols are present in shared libraries and executables. they can be referred to in relocation entries and debugging metadata.

4.2.9. relocation

relocations are metadata table entries used to update relocatable addresses during linking. relocations contains a type, a file offset pointing to text or data, and a pointer to a symbol name whose address needs to be updated during the linking step. relocations can be present in object files and dynamic relocations are present in shared libraries and executables.

4.2.10. program linking

program linking is the process of combining multiple relocatable object files by merging and aligning sections, resolving symbol references across files, assigning final symbol addresses, applying relocation fixups using relocation entries, and adding debug metadata.

4. Assembly

4.3. Directives

the assembler implements a number of directives that control the assembly of instructions into object files. these directives are based on the AT&T System V assembler [2] and the GNU assembler [5], with some additions. they provide the ability to include arbitrary data, align data, export symbols, switch sections, define constants, and emit metadata.

the following table lists glyph assembler directives:

Directive	Arguments	Description
Data directives		
<code>.byte</code>	<i>expression-list</i>	8-bit comma separated words
<code>.short</code>	<i>expression-list</i>	16-bit comma separated words
<code>.long</code>	<i>expression-list</i>	32-bit comma separated words
<code>.quad</code>	<i>expression-list</i>	64-bit comma separated words
<code>.octa</code>	<i>expression-list</i>	128-bit comma separated words
<code>.string</code>	<i>"string"</i>	emit string
<code>.zero</code>	<i>integer</i>	emit zeroes
Alignment directives		
<code>.align</code>	<i>pow2 [,pad_val=0] [,max]</i>	align to power of 2
<code>.balign</code>	<i>bytes [,pad_val=0]</i>	byte align
Symbol directives		
<code>.globl</code>	<i>symbol_name,const_name</i>	emit symbol (<i>global scope</i>)
<code>.local</code>	<i>symbol_name,const_name</i>	emit symbol (<i>local scope</i>)
Section directives		
<code>.text</code>	<i>symbol_name,size,align</i> <i>section_name</i>	emit <code>.text</code> section or make current
<code>.const</code>		emit <code>.const</code> section or make current
<code>.data</code>		emit <code>.data</code> section or make current
<code>.rodata</code>		emit <code>.rodata</code> section or make current
<code>.bss</code>		emit <code>.bss</code> section or make current
<code>.common</code>		emit common object to <code>.bss</code> section
<code>.section</code>		emit section (default <code>.text</code>) or make current
Miscellaneous directives		
<code>.equ</code>	<i>name, value</i>	constant definition
<code>.file</code>	<i>"filename"</i>	emit filename symbol
<code>.ident</code>	<i>"string"</i>	emit identification string
<code>.size</code>	<i>symbol,symbol</i>	emit symbol size
<code>.type</code>	<i>symbol,@function</i>	emit symbol type

Table 4.1.: Assembler directives

4. Assembly

4.4. Pseudo-instructions

the assembler implements a number of convenience psuedo-instruction aliases that are formed from regular instructions, but have implicit or deduced arguments.

the following table lists glyph assembler pseudo instruction aliases:

Pseudo-instruction	Expansion	Description
<code>nop</code>	<code>or.i64 r0,r0,r0</code>	no-operation
<code>li rc, expression</code>	(several expansions)	load immediate
<code>la rc, symbol</code>	(several expansions)	load address
<code>call symbol</code>	<code>jalib.i64 ibcall(text-label,const-label)</code>	procedure call
<code>ret</code>	<code>jtlib.i64 ibret(text-label,const-label)</code>	procedure return
<code>jib.i64 ib64(uimm6)</code>	<code>link.i64 ib64(uimm6), jib</code>	jump-immmediate-block
<code>jalib.i64 rc, ib64(uimm6)</code>	<code>link.i64 rc, ib64(uimm6), jalib</code>	jump-and-link-immmediate-block
<code>jtlib.i64 rc, ib64(uimm6)</code>	<code>link.i64 rc, ib64(uimm6), jtlib</code>	jump-to-link-immmediate-block
<code>jalaib.i64 rc, ib64(uimm6)</code>	<code>link.i64 rc, ib64(uimm6), jalaib</code>	jump-and-link-add-immmediate-block
<code>cmp.lt.i64 rc, rb</code>	<code>compare.i64 rc, rb, lt</code>	compare less than (signed)
<code>cmp.gt.i64 rc, rb</code>	<code>compare.i64 rb, rc, lt</code>	compare greater than (signed)
<code>cmp.le.i64 rc, rb</code>	<code>compare.i64 rb, rc, ge</code>	compare less or equal (signed)
<code>cmp.ge.i64 rc, rb</code>	<code>compare.i64 rc, rb, ge</code>	compare greater or equal (signed)
<code>cmp.eq.i64 rc, rb</code>	<code>compare.i64 rc, rb, eq</code>	compare equal
<code>cmp.ne.i64 rc, rb</code>	<code>compare.i64 rc, rb, ne</code>	compare not equal
<code>cmp.ltu.i64 rc, rb</code>	<code>compare.i64 rc, rb, ltu</code>	compare less than (unsigned)
<code>cmp.gtu.i64 rc, rb</code>	<code>compare.i64 rb, rc, ltu</code>	compare greater than (unsigned)
<code>cmp.leu.i64 rc, rb</code>	<code>compare.i64 rb, rc, geu</code>	compare less or equal (unsigned)
<code>cmp.geu.i64 rc, rb</code>	<code>compare.i64 rc, rb, geu</code>	compare greater or equal (unsigned)
<code>cmov.i64 rc, rb</code>	<code>compare.i64 rc, rb, cmov</code>	conditional move
<code>ncmov.i64 rc, rb</code>	<code>compare.i64 rc, rb, ncmov</code>	negated conditional move
<code>mov.i64 rc, rb</code>	<code>logic.i64 rc, rb, mov</code>	copy register
<code>not.i64 rc, rb</code>	<code>logic.i64 rc, rb, not</code>	logical not
<code>neg.i64 rc, rb</code>	<code>logic.i64 rc, rb, neg</code>	signed negate
<code>bswap.i64 rc, rb</code>	<code>logic.i64 rc, rb, bswap</code>	byte swap
<code>ctz.i64 rc, rb</code>	<code>logic.i64 rc, rb, ctz</code>	count trailing zeros
<code>clz.i64 rc, rb</code>	<code>logic.i64 rc, rb, clz</code>	count leading zeroes
<code>ctpop.i64 rc, rb</code>	<code>logic.i64 rc, rb, ctpop</code>	count population
<code>sext.i64 rc, rb</code>	<code>logic.i64 rc, rb, sext</code>	sign extend

Table 4.2.: Pseudo instructions

4.5. Calling convention

4.5.1. calling convention — 16-bit

the 16-bit instruction packet, while intended to be used in conjunction with the larger opcodes, is designed as a complete subset, so there is an ABI variant that targets a subset of the instruction set architecture that only uses the 16-bit opcodes.

the register assignment for the 16-bit subset was chosen with this rationale:

- 2 blocks of 4 contiguous non-volatile *callee-save* and volatile *caller-save* registers.
- 3 special registers, 2 argument registers, 1 temporary register, and 3 save registers.
- 3 save registers to avoid excessive spilling around function calls.
- 1 temporary register to avoid spilling arguments to free a temporary.

the calling convention for the 16-bit subset is as follows:

- *immediate base* `ib` is set by `call` instructions and must point to a valid immediate block on function entry. function symbols are exported with two labels; one in the `.text` section, and one in the `.const` section. *immediate base* must be restored to the entry value in the function *epilogue* before it can be restored by `ret`.
- *argument registers* `a0` and `a1` are used for the first two arguments, and the remaining arguments are passed on the stack. *return value* is places in `a0` and `a1`, *temporary register* `t0` is a volatile register, and *frame pointer* (if enabled) uses `s0`. there are two more non-volatile *callee-save* registers, `s1` and `s2`.

the following table outlines the 16-bit register allocation showing register name alias, description, and non-volatile *callee-save* or volatile *caller-save* status.

name	alias	description	save
<code>ib</code>		immediate base	callee
<code>r0</code>	<code>sp</code>	stack pointer	callee
<code>r1</code>	<code>s0/fp</code>	saved register 0 / frame pointer	callee
<code>r2</code>	<code>s1</code>	saved register 1	callee
<code>r3</code>	<code>s2</code>	saved register 2	callee
<code>r4</code>	<code>a0</code>	argument register 0	caller
<code>r5</code>	<code>a1</code>	argument register 1	caller
<code>r6</code>	<code>t0</code>	temporary register 0	caller
<code>r7</code>	<code>ra</code>	return address / (pc,ib) link vector	caller

Table 4.3.: 16-bit register assignment

A. Appendix

A.1. Opcode summary — 16-bit

15	13	12	10	9	7	6	2	1	0	
operand						opcode		size		
uimm						00000		00		break uimm9
simm						00001		00		j simm9 × 2
simm						00010		00		b simm9 × 2
simm						00011		00		ibj simm9 × 64
fun	uimm					00100		00		link.i64 fun3, ib64(uimm6)
rc	uimm					00101		00		movh.i64 rc, ib32(uimm6)
rc	uimm					00110		00		movw.i64 rc, ib64(uimm6)
rc	simm					00111		00		movi.i64 rc, simm6
rc	simm					01000		00		addi.i64 rc, simm6
rc	uimm					01001		00		srli.i64 rc, uimm6
rc	uimm					01010		00		srai.i64 rc, uimm6
rc	uimm					01011		00		slli.i64 rc, uimm6
rc	uimm					01100		00		addh.i64 rc, ib32(uimm6)
rc	uimm					01101		00		leapc.i64 rc, ib32(uimm6)(pc)
rc	uimm					01110		00		loadpc.i64 rc, ib32(uimm6)(pc)
rc	uimm					01111		00		storepc.i64 rc, ib32(uimm6)(pc)
rc	rb	uimm				10000		00		load.i64 rc, (uimm3 × 8)(rb)
rc	rb	uimm				10001		00		store.i64 rc, (uimm3 × 8)(rb)
rc	rb	fun				10010		00		compare.i64 rc, rb, fun3
rc	rb	fun				10011		00		logic.i64 rc, rb, fun3
rc	rb	ra				10100		00		pin.i64 rc, rb, ra
rc	rb	ra				10101		00		and.i64 rc, rb, ra
rc	rb	ra				10110		00		or.i64 rc, rb, ra
rc	rb	ra				10111		00		xor.i64 rc, rb, ra
rc	rb	ra				11000		00		add.i64 rc, rb, ra
rc	rb	ra				11001		00		srl.i64 rc, rb, ra
rc	rb	ra				11010		00		sra.i64 rc, rb, ra
rc	rb	ra				11011		00		sll.i64 rc, rb, ra
rc	rb	ra				11100		00		sub.i64 rc, rb, ra
rc	rb	ra				11101		00		mul.i64 rc, rb, ra
rc	rb	ra				11110		00		div.i64 rc, rb, ra
uimm						11111		00		illegal uimm9

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